

Section 6. Declaration for Imported Goods

6.1 General

Except in cases of fallback all import declarations must be lodged electronically via AIS (Article 6 (1) UCC).

Further information on importing goods can be found in the Guide to [Customs Import procedures](#) and on the [Customs traders and agents](#) section of the Revenue website.

6.1.1 When declarations are to be made

A declaration may be lodged up to 30 days in advance of the presentation of the goods to customs. However, the date of acceptance of the declaration is when the goods are presented. If the goods are not presented within 30 days, the declaration is deemed not to have been lodged (Article 171 UCC).

6.1.2 Who may lodge the declaration?

Declarations may be lodged by any person able to present the goods to customs or have them presented. In the majority of cases, this will be the importer or an agent acting on their behalf. The declarant must also be able to provide all the necessary information for the import procedure. The declarant must be established in the customs territory of the Union. However, this requirement may be waived (see Article 170 (3) UCC).

6.2 Processing of electronic import declarations

6.2.1 AIS

Import declarations are lodged via AIS which is responsible for the validation, processing, duty accounting, control and clearance of customs declarations for imports, in compliance with the provisions of the UCC. The system also checks data format, preferential rates, prohibitions/restrictions and verifies that sufficient credit is available in the relevant account to cover the import liability.

The [AIS Trader Guide](#) contains detailed information on the different declaration types that can be lodged into AIS and their corresponding data elements.

6.2.2 Applications

A trader and/or their Customs agent must be approved by the AIS eCustoms Helpdesk (application forms are available for download on the Revenue website) and be in receipt of a digital certificate from ROS in order to make an electronic declaration.